

▼ SMLE (SHORT MAGAZINE LEE-ENFIELD) MKIII RIFLE WITH WIRE-CUTTER ATTACHMENT

Date 1907

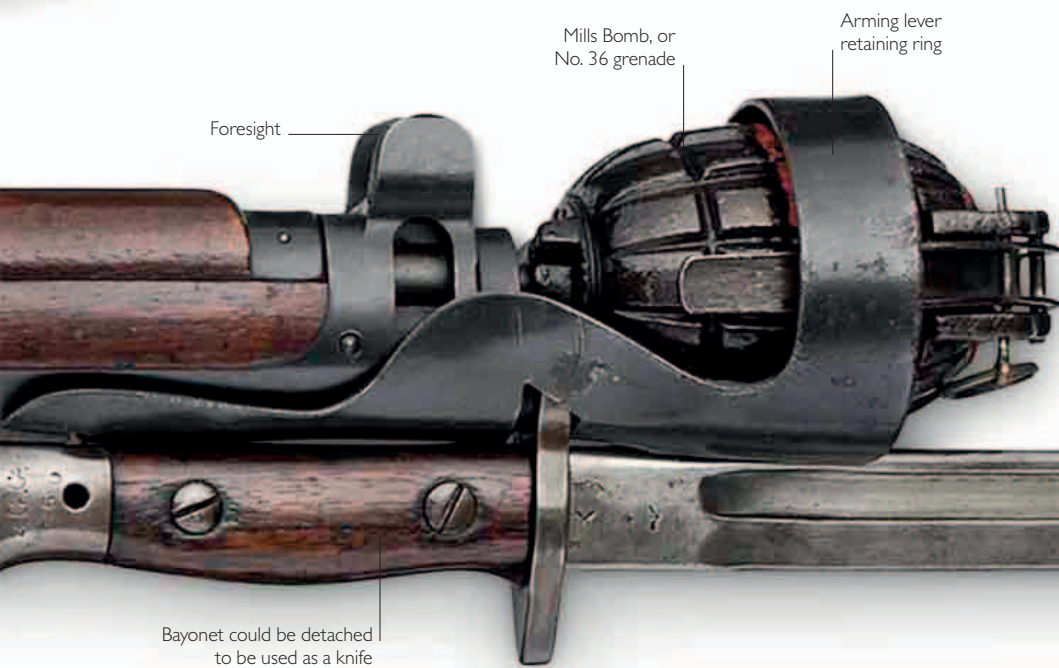
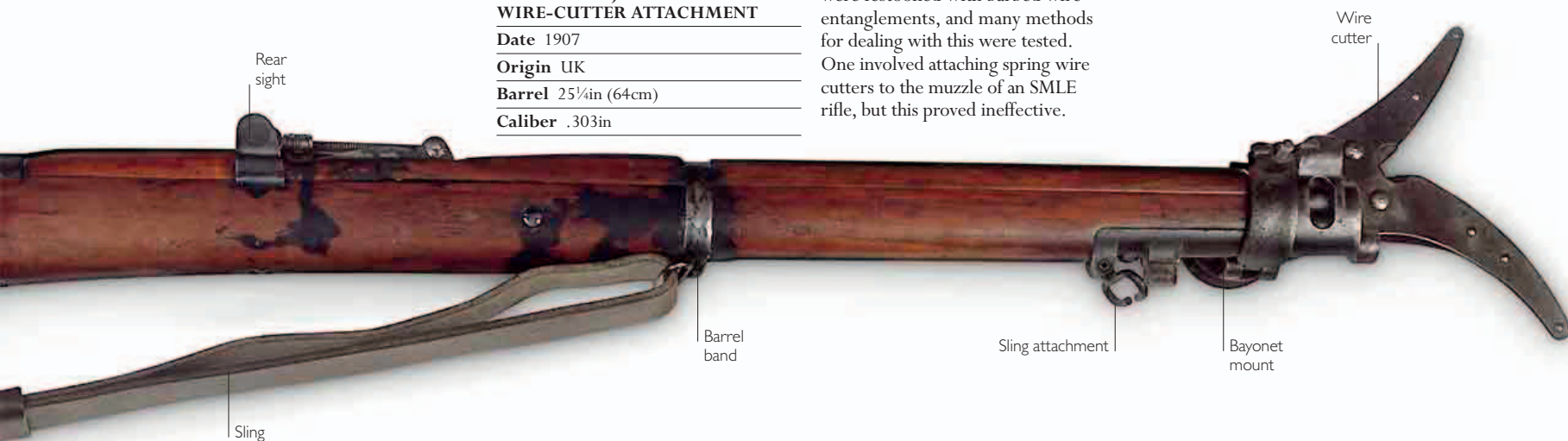
Origin UK

Barrel 25¼in (64cm)

Caliber .303in

The battlefields of World War I were festooned with barbed wire entanglements, and many methods for dealing with this were tested.

One involved attaching spring wire cutters to the muzzle of an SMLE rifle, but this proved ineffective.



◀ SMLE WITH MILLS BOMB LAUNCHER

Date 1915

Origin UK

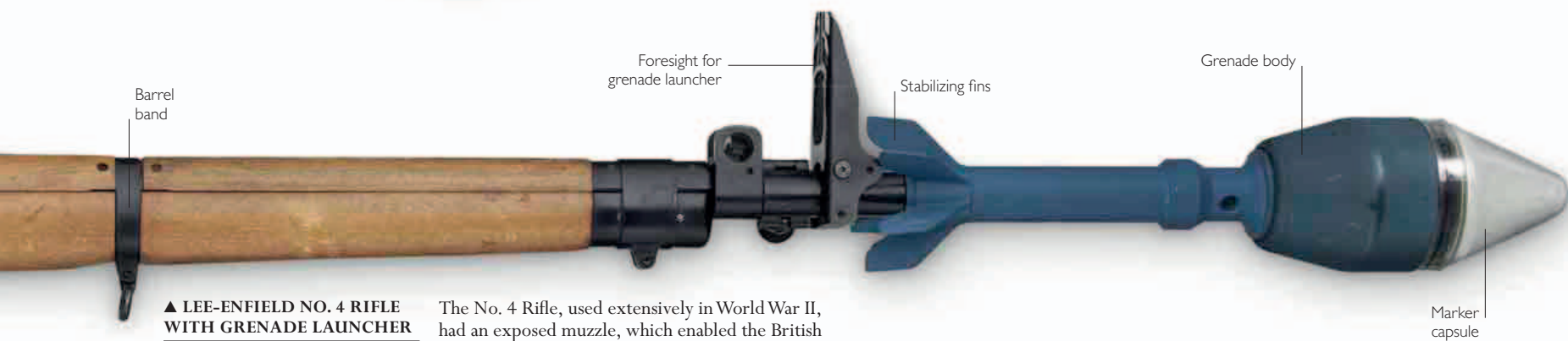
Barrel 25¼in (64cm)

Caliber .303in

Range 500ft (150m)

Grenade type Antipersonnel

The Mills Bomb was adapted for rifle-use by the addition of a rod to the base cap. The rifle itself was fitted with a ring or cup, mounted at the bayonet lug, to retain the grenade's arming lever. To fire the grenade, a specially formulated blank cartridge was used.



▲ LEE-ENFIELD NO. 4 RIFLE WITH GRENADE LAUNCHER

Date 1940s

Origin UK

Barrel 30in (76.2cm)

Caliber .303in

Range 330ft (100m)

Grenade type Antitank

The No. 4 Rifle, used extensively in World War II, had an exposed muzzle, which enabled the British Army to develop a new style of tubular launcher. The rifle could launch a fin-stabilized antitank grenade, which was mounted over its muzzle on the bayonet lugs. Using a powerful blank cartridge, it was fired with the butt of the rifle grounded. This example is equipped with a later model L1A1 practice grenade.